Are You Ready for Commitment?

Static Sites, Quire, and the Joy of Being in It for the Long Haul



Erin Cecele Dunigan

MCN 2026

Greetings from Getty*



*aka heaven on *The Good Place*

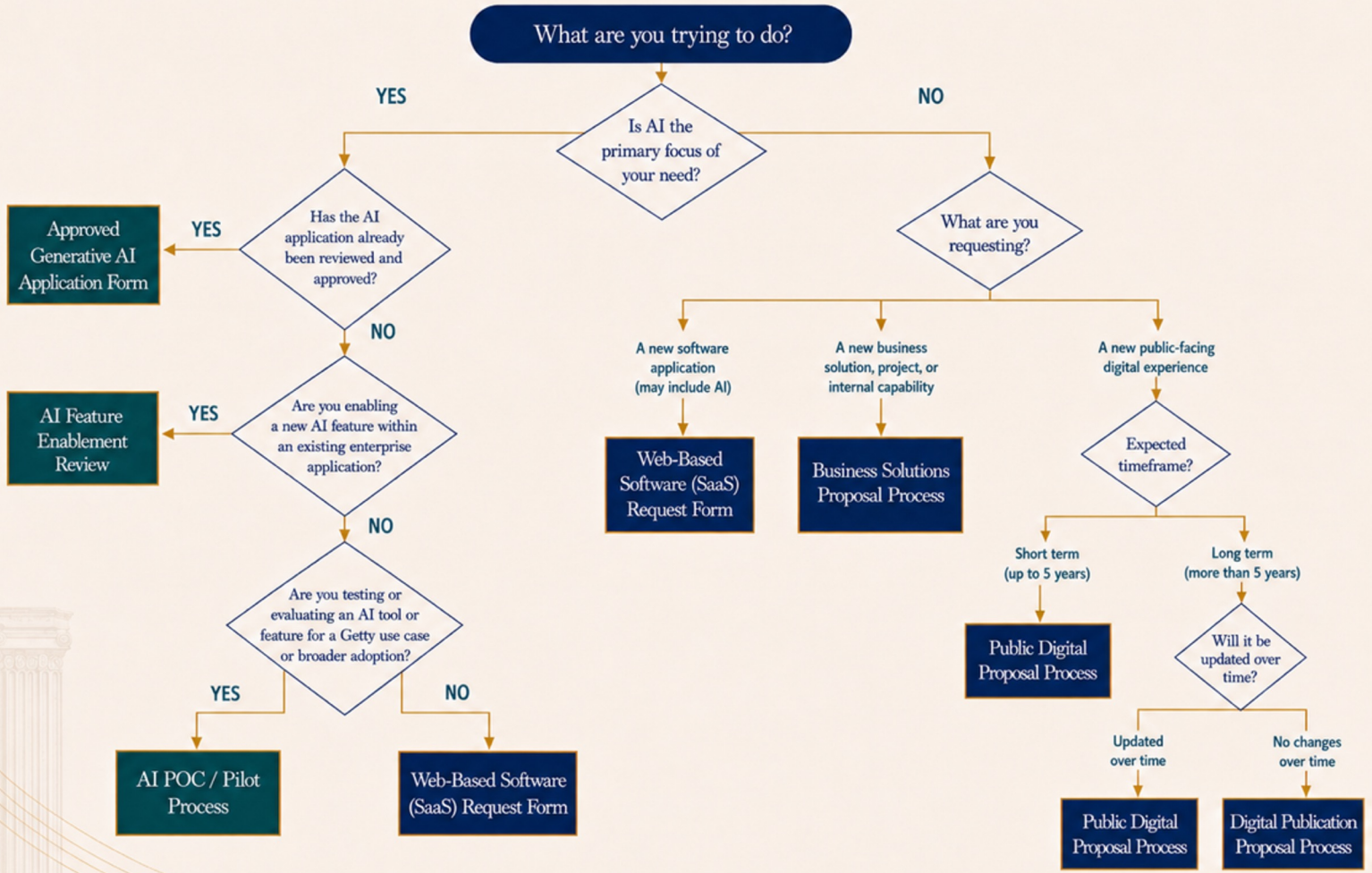
Digital Governance at Getty

- Officially launched in May 2024
- A committee reviews proposals quarterly, offering guidance and revision advice
- Final proposals are sent to senior leadership for approval; culture of “not now” instead of “no”
- As Getty Digital is centralized, this has led to a better prioritization of resources
- Helps maintain consistency, security, and efficiency across digital platforms and operations
- Process has also encouraged more conversations across the institution leading to a better awareness of colleagues’ workloads



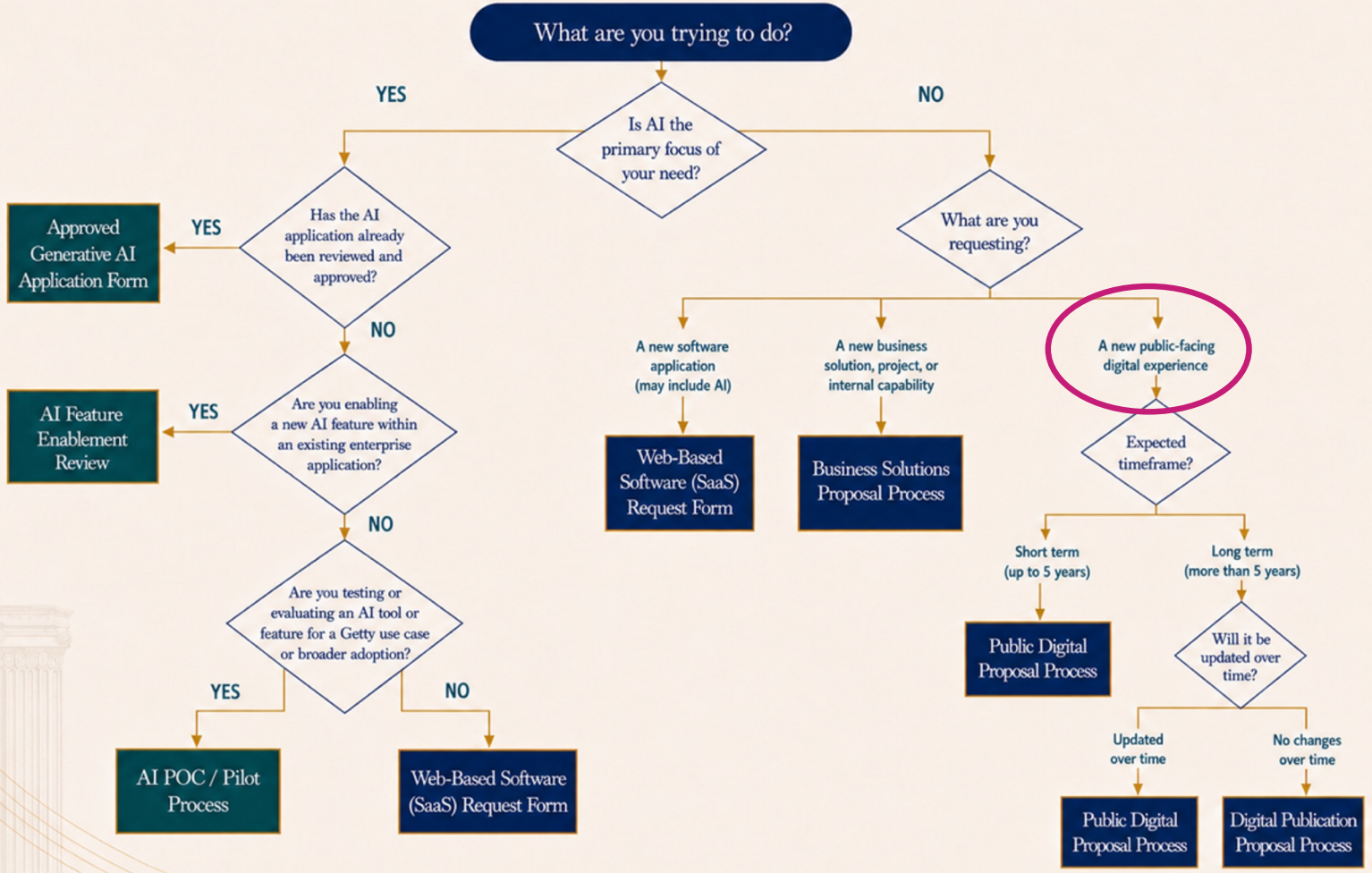
Which Process Should I Use?

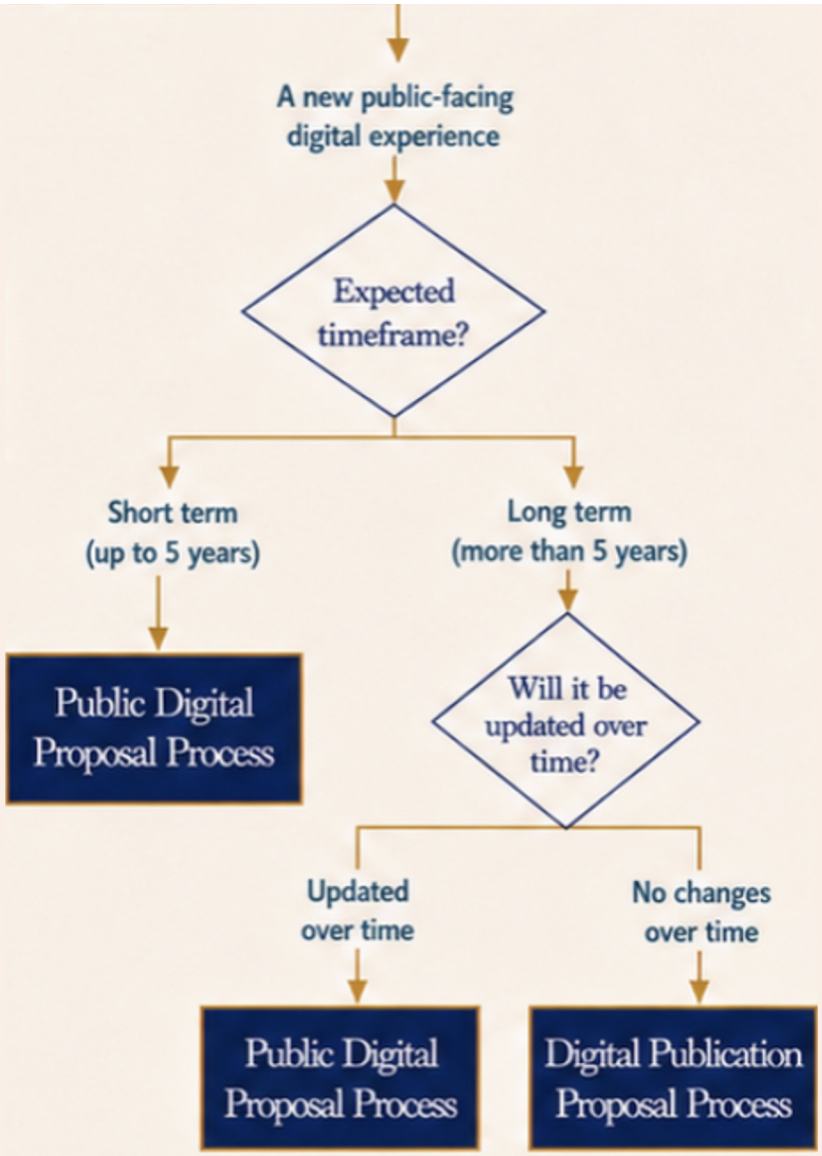
Not sure where to start? Use the guide below to find the right process.

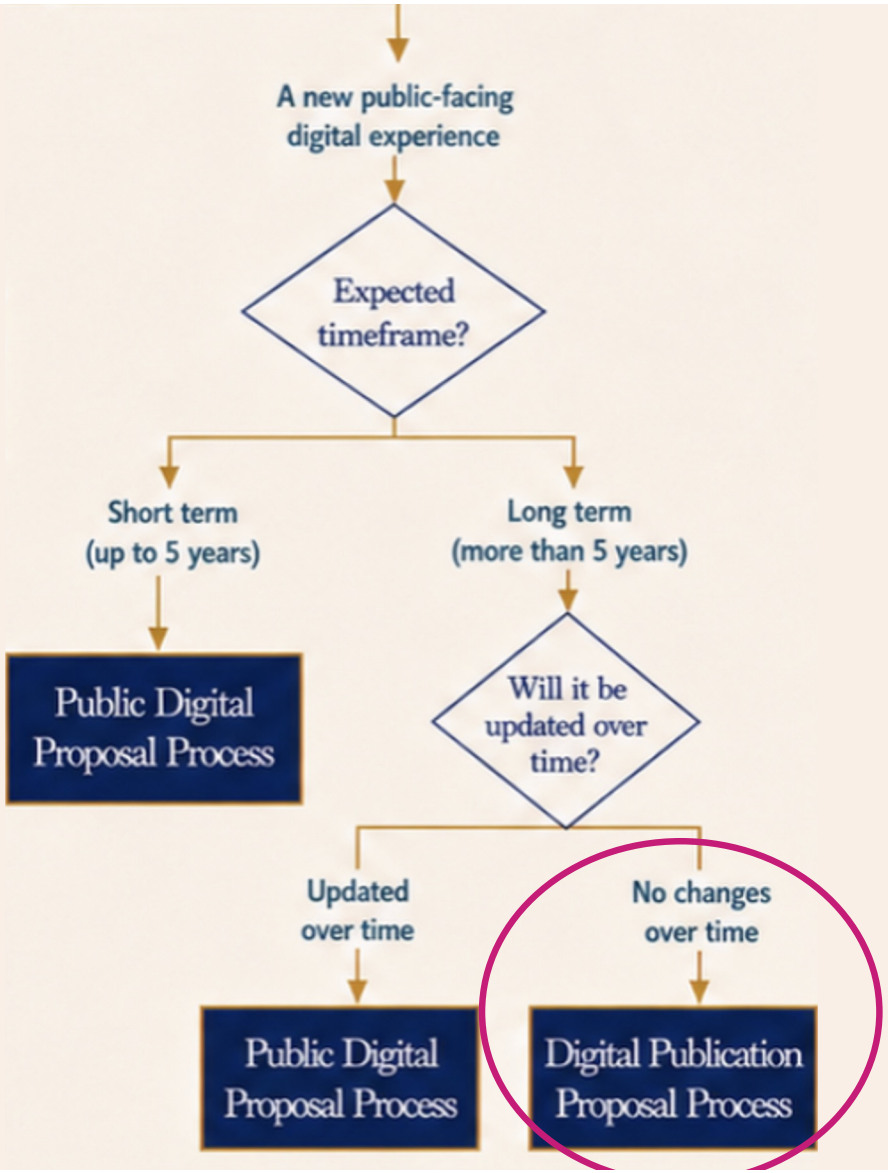


Which Process Should I Use?

Not sure where to start? Use the guide below to find the right process.




A new public-facing digital experience
Expected timeframe?
Short term (up to 5 years)
Long term (more than 5 years)
Public Digital Proposal Process
Will it be updated over time?
Updated over time
No changes over time
Public Digital Proposal Process
Digital Publication Proposal Process


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Digital Publication Proposal Process

quire

About Community Docs v0 Docs v1 Resources Get Started

Create scholarly, visually rich digital books that last

Online · Print · E-book

Quire is an open-source multiformat publishing tool designed for longevity, discoverability, and scholarship. Using a single set of plain text files, Quire creates books as authoritative and enduring as print and as vibrant and feature-rich as the web—all without paying a fee or maintaining a complicated server.

Created by Getty, free to use.

Get Started

View on GitHub



Quire Goals

DISCOVERABILITY

Multiformat output (website, PDF, e-book, and print) to ensure Quire books are available everywhere

Open access ensures greater reach of scholarship that otherwise might have remained hidden

LONGEVITY

No proprietary software, complicated servers, or long-term maintenance

Plain-text files and print fall-backs mean scholarship can live on even if technology breaks

SUSTAINABILITY

Open-source tool that anyone can use for free without prior technical skills or knowledge

Community contributions and engagement ensure long-term health and well-being of the tool

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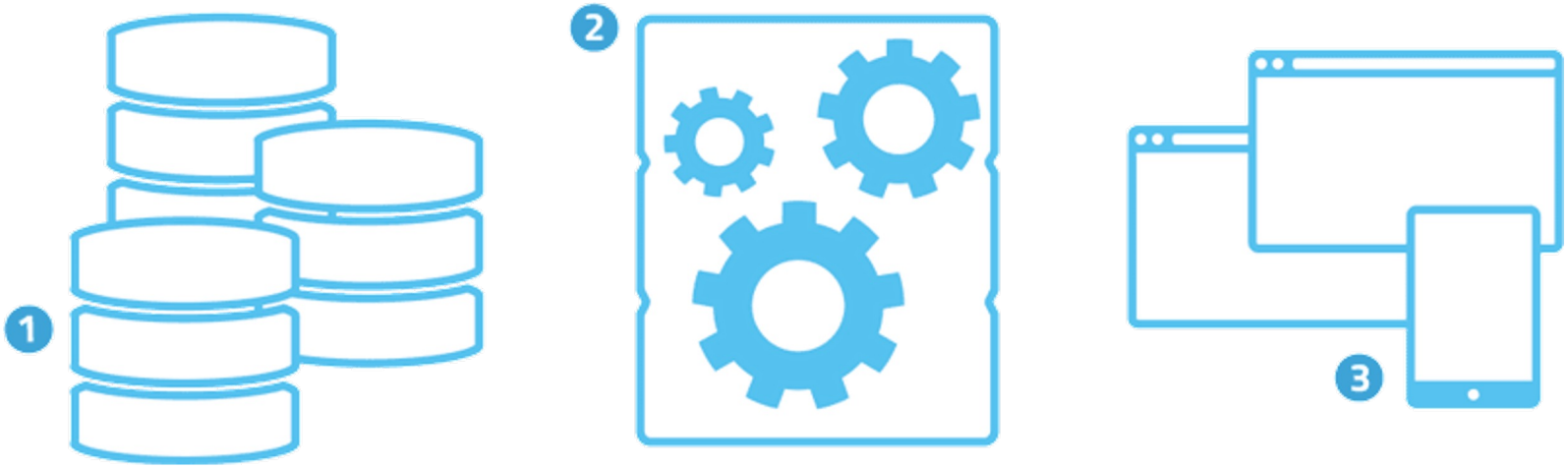
Community contributions and engagement ensure long-term health and well-being of the tool


IF YOU LIKE IT THEN
YOU SHOULD'VE MADE IT A STATIC SITE

What are Static Sites?

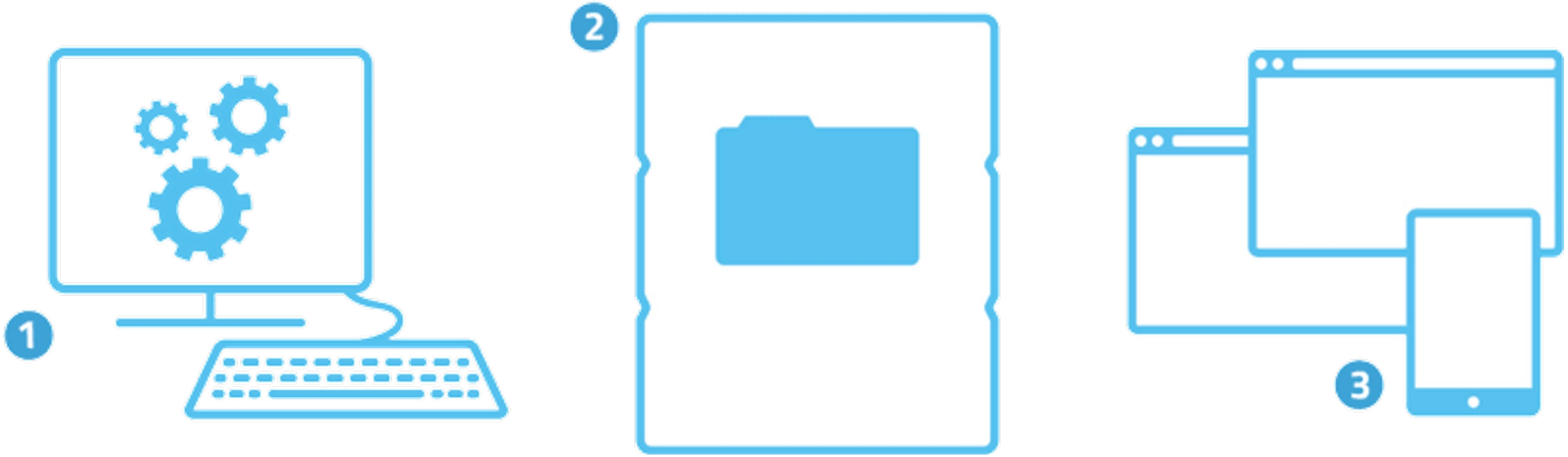
- Websites made up of *only* static HTML, CSS, and JavaScript files
- Site files are pre-built with no database or server-side script necessary
- Typically include:
  - A compiling tool that builds the final site files
  - Templating language for layout and theming
  - Markup language for content creation
  - Local development server to preview and test the site
- Relative of the hand-coded HTML sites of the 1990s, they became popular again in the 2010's after dynamic-site drawbacks became clear
- Don't be fooled by the name! They have evolved over the years to include dynamic content and interactivity (for ex. pagination, search, data visualizations, etc.)
- Examples of popular static site generators are 11ty, Hugo, and Jekyll

Dynamic Site Building



A CMS is connected to collections and image databases (1) and set up on a server (2). The CMS is used to create the website. Once the website is published, the CMS rebuilds the site pages each time they are loaded by a user (3). Thus, the CMS must be kept running for the lifetime of the publication.

Static Site Building



The CMS is just software and a folder of files on your computer, (1) that is used to build the site. The site files are then uploaded to the server (2), where users can access them directly (3). You only need to run the site software and upload new files if you want to update the publication

Benefits of Static Sites

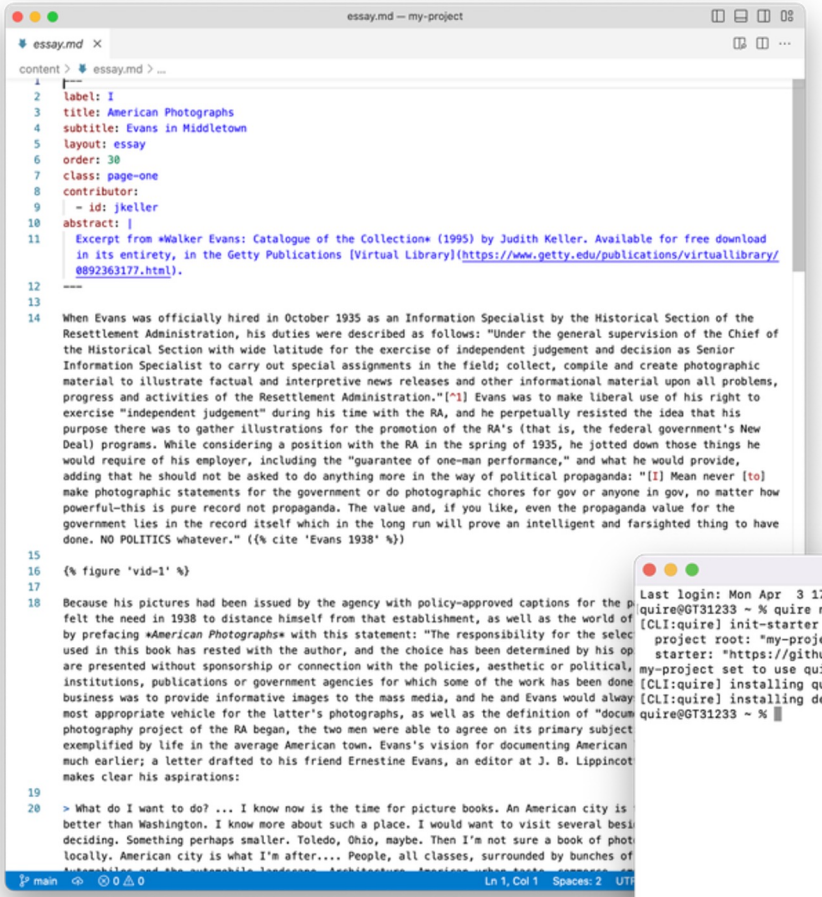
- **Cheap**: Usually free and open-source with inexpensive hosting and no server to maintain
- **Fast**: Delivers pre-built files directly to visitors, shifting site-building to publication time
- **Secure**: No database, CMS plugins, or server-side applications creating additional risk
- **Durable**: Smaller/simpler than many dynamic sites, handles heavy traffic and bots well
- **Portable**: No proprietary software, just a folder of files that can be hosted almost anywhere
- **Low-maintenance**: Requires fewer computing resources
- **Long-lasting**: Easy to preserve because content is stored as files rather than in a database



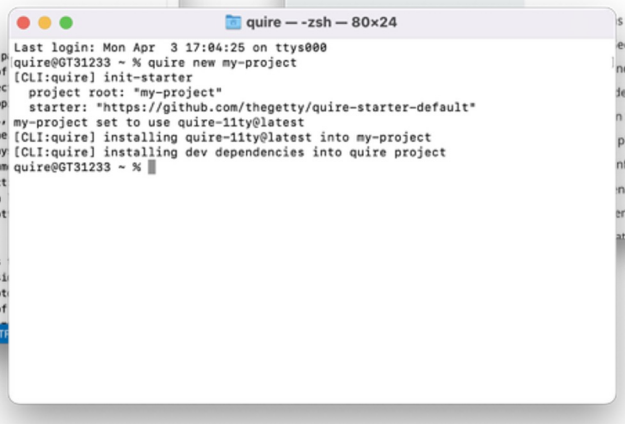
Drawbacks of Static Sites

- **Change is "hard"**: Changes typically require rebuilding and redeploying the site
- **Less flexible**: Doesn't accommodate many users, roles, or visitor-generated content
- **Needs upfront investment:** Time and labor is needed to build and design the *initial* site, there is also a learning curve for content creators unfamiliar with Markdown, the command-line, etc.

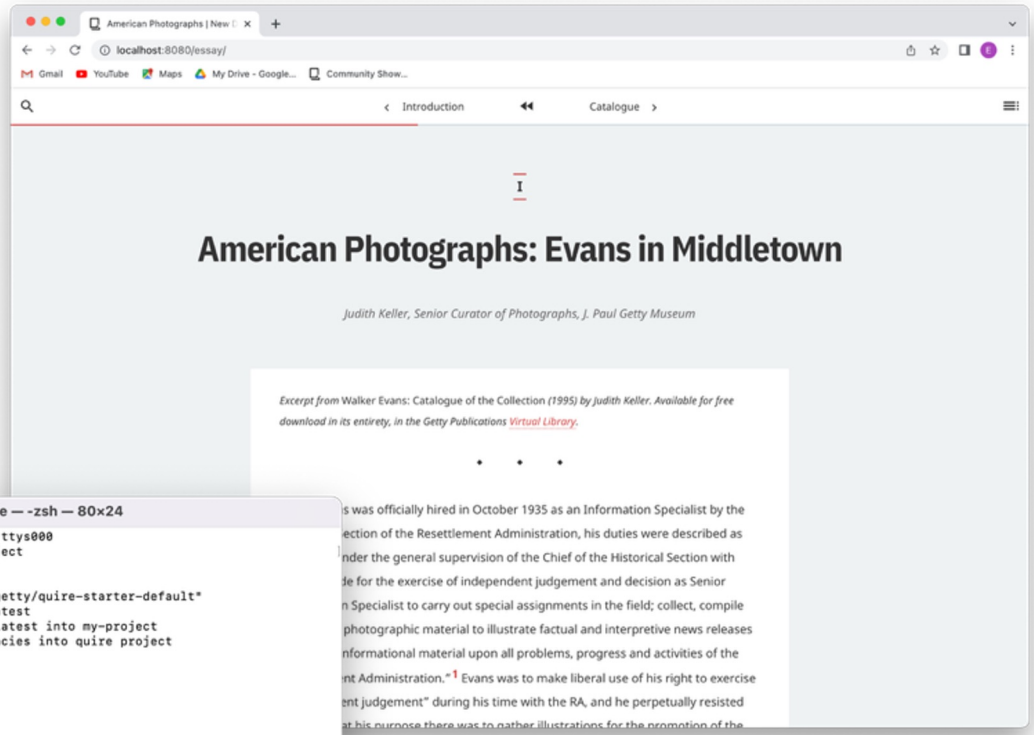




Edit publication files in a text editor



Operate Quire in a command-line shell



Preview the results in a web browser

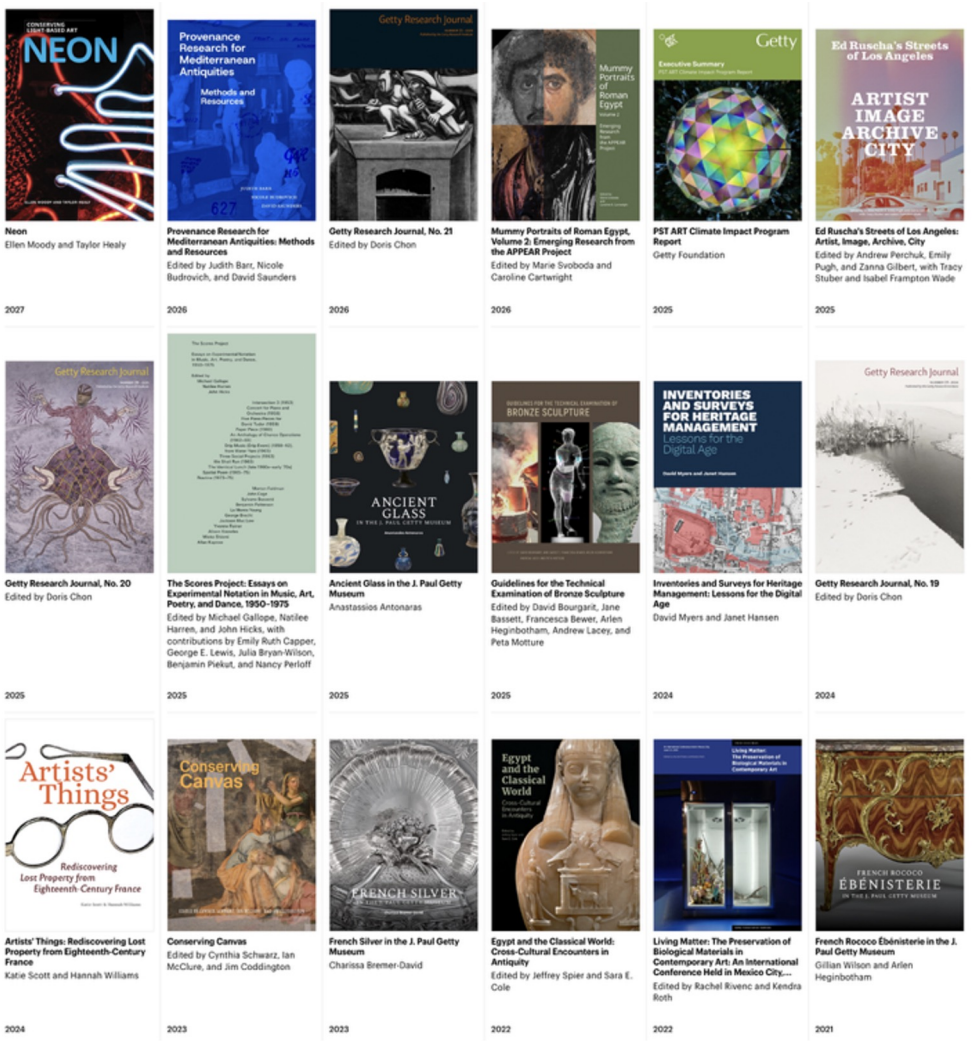
When Does Getty Use Quire?

Public-facing digital projects that need to last a long time with rare updates

Books that have too small of an audience or are too expensive to produce

Scholarly works that benefit from reaching a large audience, otherwise limited in print

Scholarship that stands to be elevated by the digital experience



Neon
Ellen Moody and Taylor Healy
2027

Provenance Research for Mediterranean Antiquities: Methods and Resources
Edited by Judith Barr, Nicole Budrovich, and David Saunders
2026

Getty Research Journal, No. 21
Edited by Doris Chon
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Mummy Portraits of Roman Egypt, Volume 2: Emerging Research from the APPEAR Project
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Living Matter: The Preservation of Biological Materials in Contemporary Art: An International Conference Held in Mexico City,...
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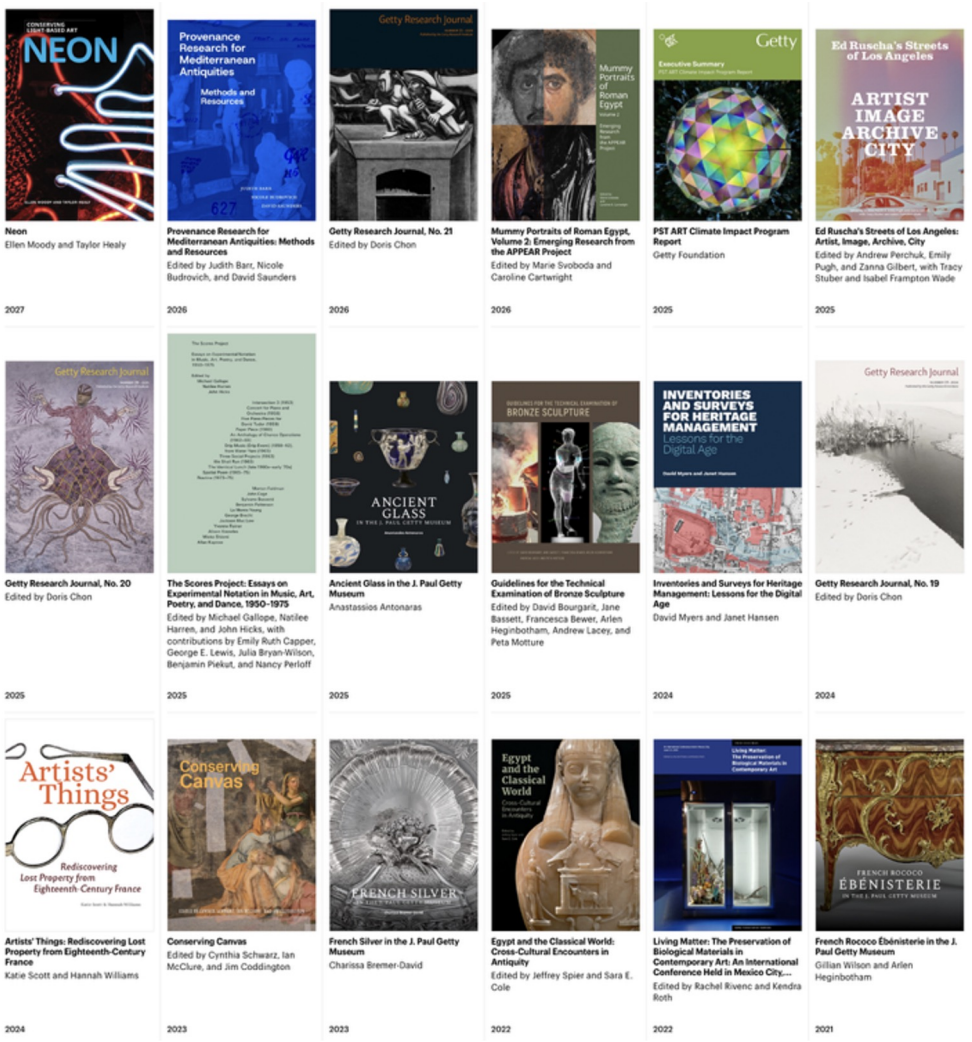
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Like a Book But Better!

BOOK-LIKE

Clear boundaries so readers know when they are in the publication.

Follows traditional book-like structure: linear navigation, citations, ISBNs, etc.

Integration of scholarly publishing best practices

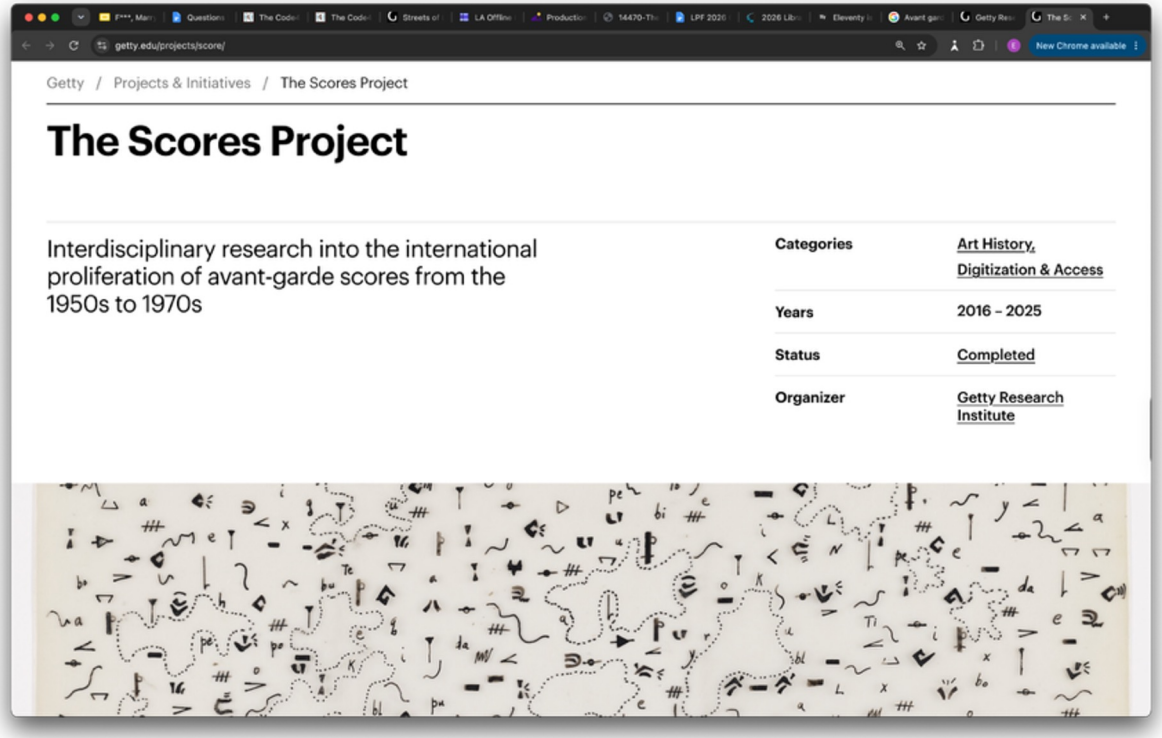
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DIGITAL FEATURES

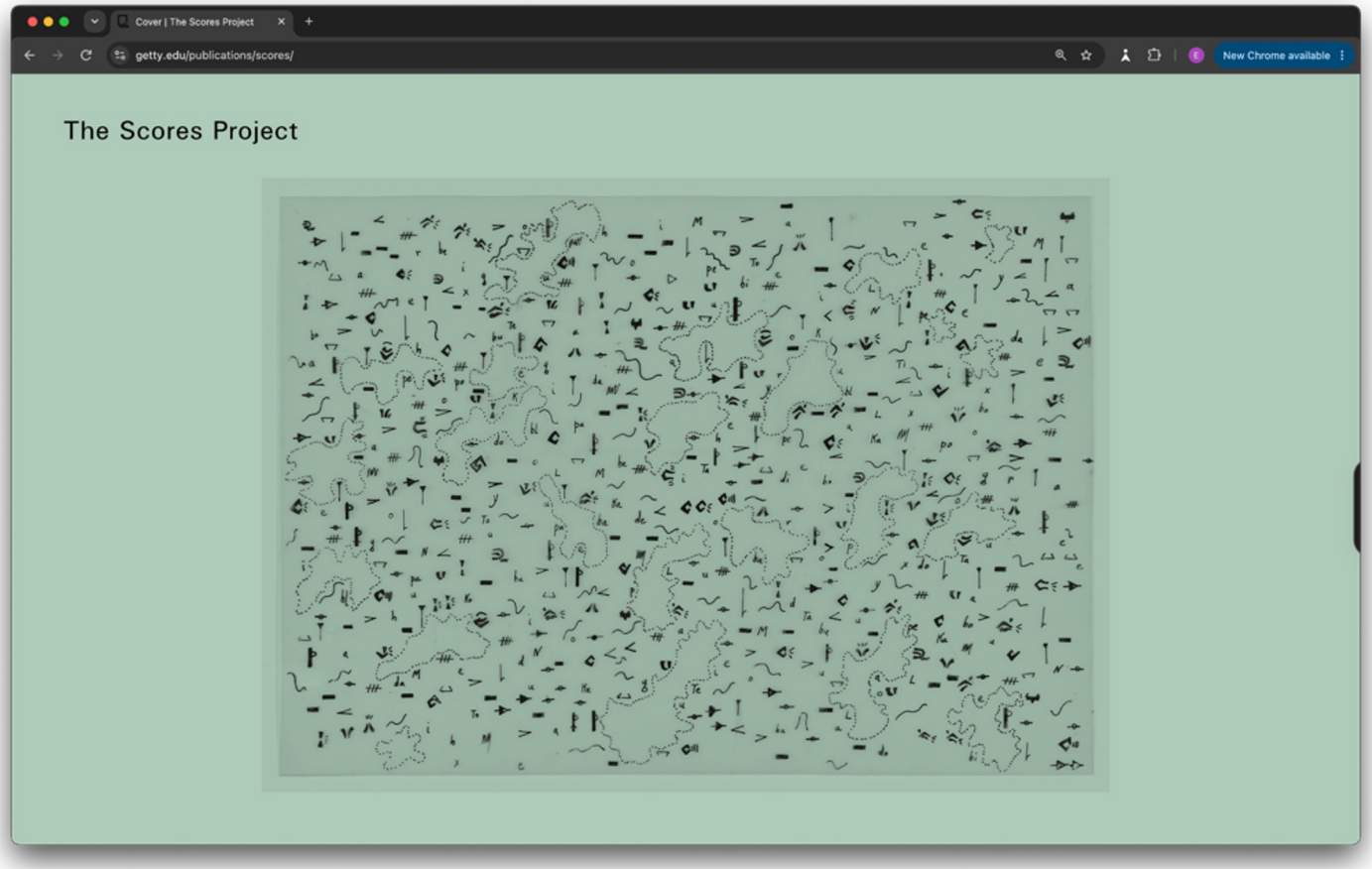
High-res zooming images (IIIF)
Rotating images
Layered and annotated images
Scrolly-telling
Audio
Video
Catalogue object sorting
Collapsible sections
Pop-up citations
Pop-up glossary definitions

The Scores Project

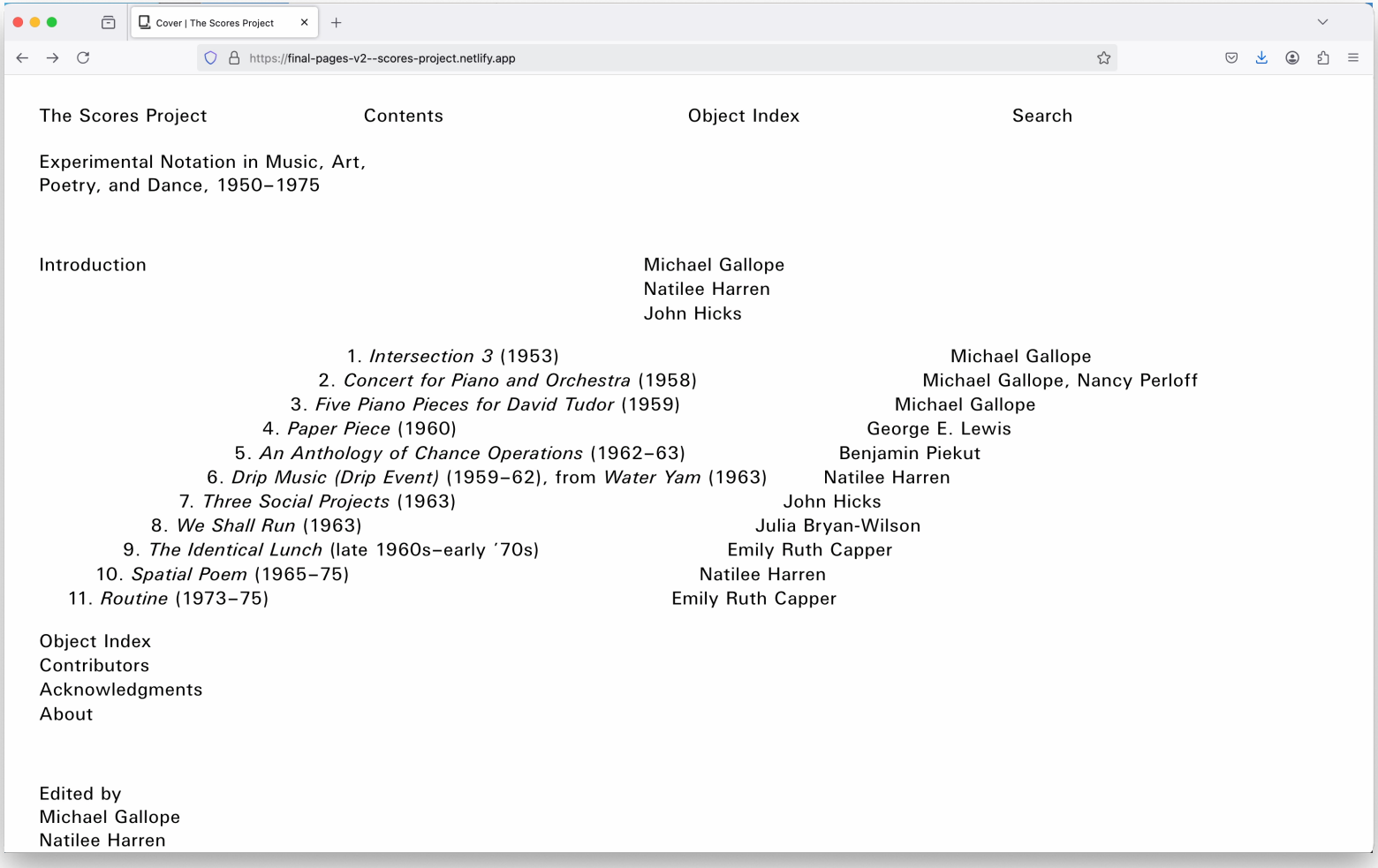
Goal: Create immersive, multimedia experience to accompany a scholarly examination of experimental scores developed by avant-garde composers, visual artists, dancers, and poets from the 1950s to the 1970s.



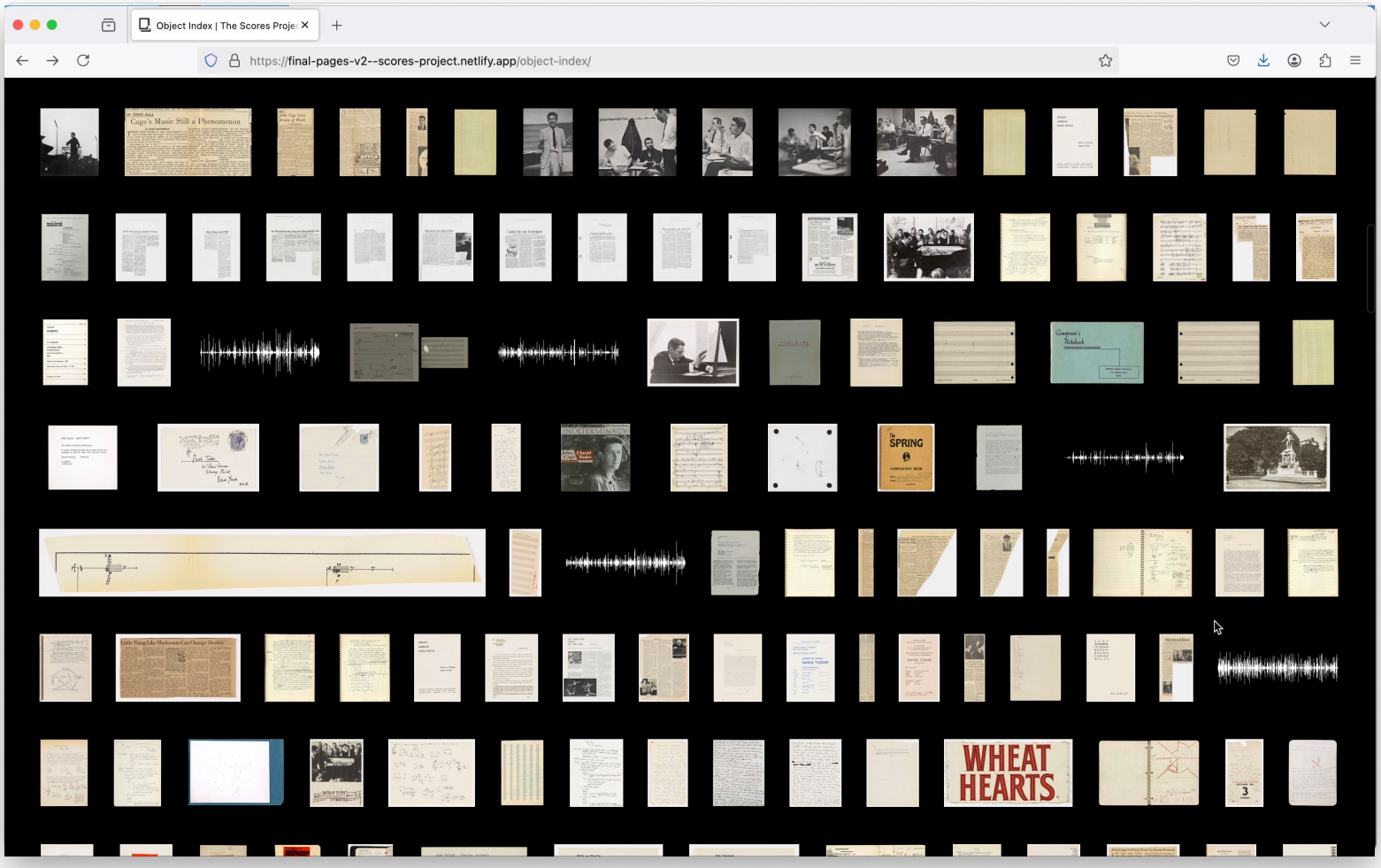
The project is a unique collaboration between digital publishing technologists, curators, art historians, musicologists, and literary scholars who want to find a way to bring together typically segregated formats (printed books, physical exhibitions, recordings, and live performance) into one comprehensive overview.



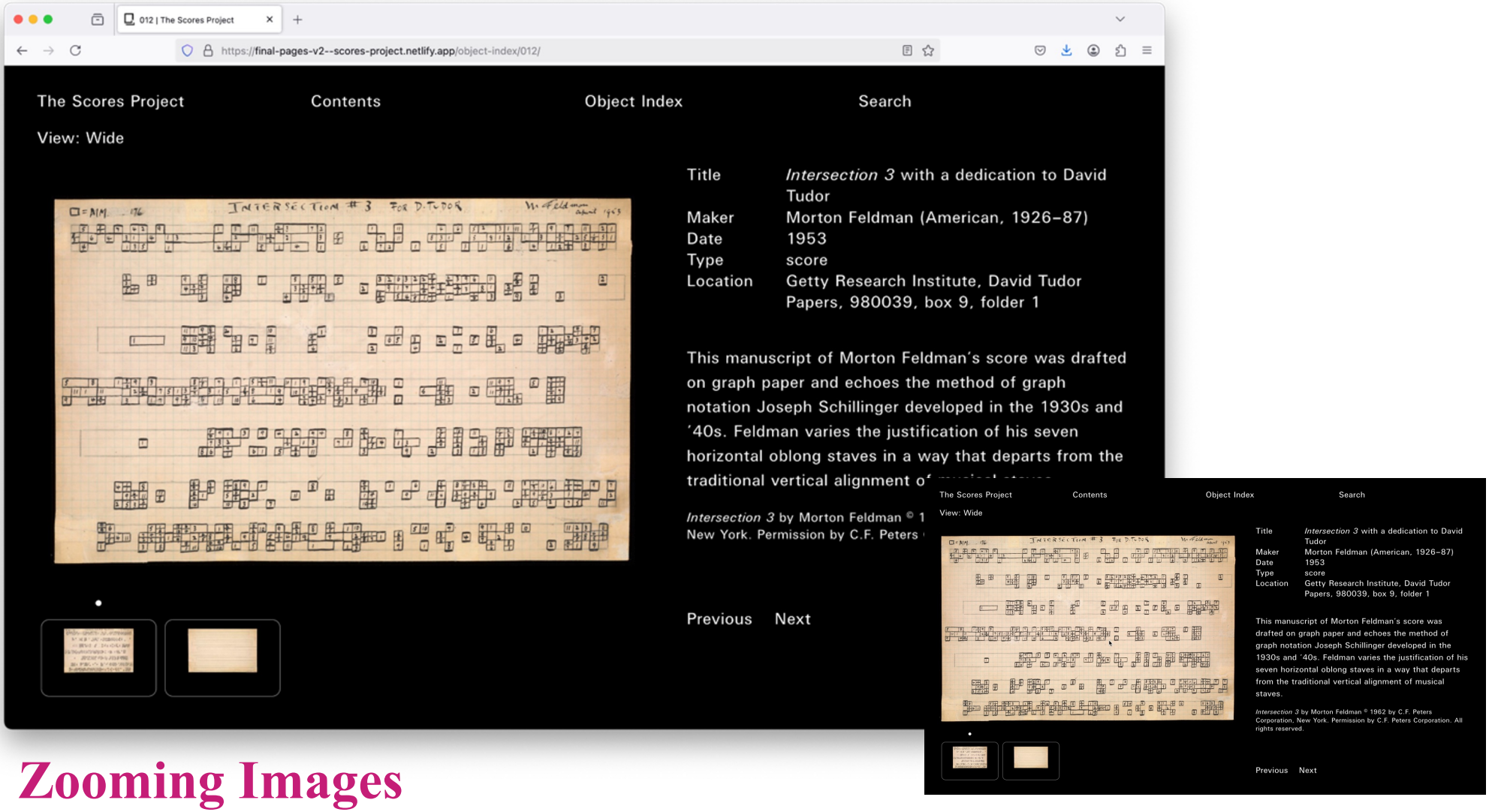
Result: A digital publication integrating text, images, audio, and video drawn from the Getty Research Institute's holdings that are integrated into a unified digital interface built to last.
https://www.getty.edu/publications/scores/


Cover | The Scores Project
https://final-pages-v2--scores-project.netlify.app
The Scores Project
Contents
Object Index
Search
Experimental Notation in Music, Art, Poetry, and Dance, 1950–1975
Introduction
Michael Gallope
Natilee Harren
John Hicks
1. *Intersection 3* (1953)
Michael Gallope
2. *Concert for Piano and Orchestra* (1958)
Michael Gallope, Nancy Perloff
3. *Five Piano Pieces for David Tudor* (1959)
Michael Gallope
4. *Paper Piece* (1960)
George E. Lewis
5. *An Anthology of Chance Operations* (1962–63)
Benjamin Piekut
6. *Drip Music (Drip Event)* (1959–62), from *Water Yam* (1963)
Natilee Harren
7. *Three Social Projects* (1963)
John Hicks
8. *We Shall Run* (1963)
Julia Bryan-Wilson
9. *The Identical Lunch* (late 1960s–early '70s)
Emily Ruth Capper
10. *Spatial Poem* (1965–75)
Natilee Harren
11. *Routine* (1973–75)
Emily Ruth Capper
Object Index
Contributors
Acknowledgments
About
Edited by
Michael Gallope
Natilee Harren

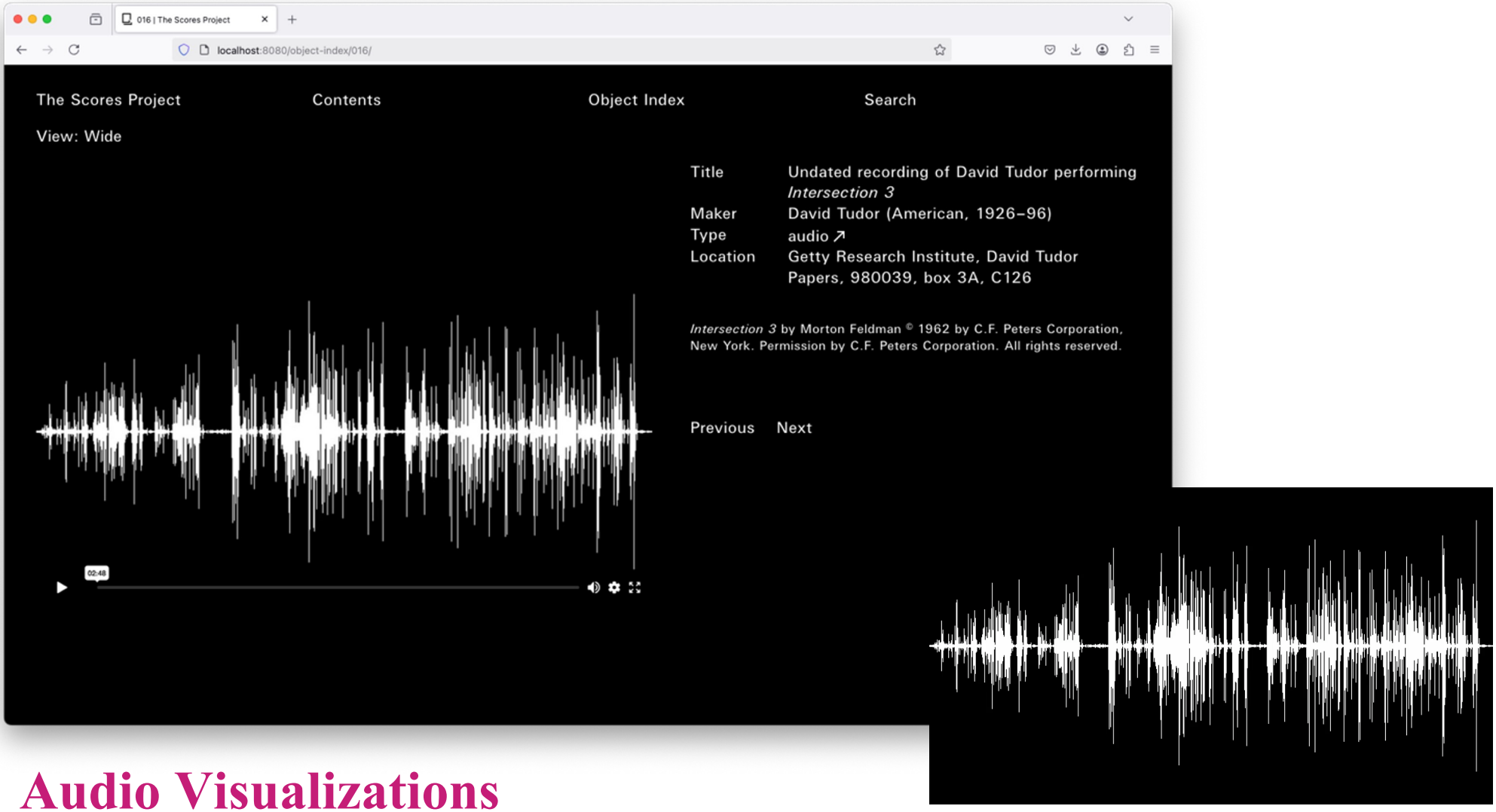
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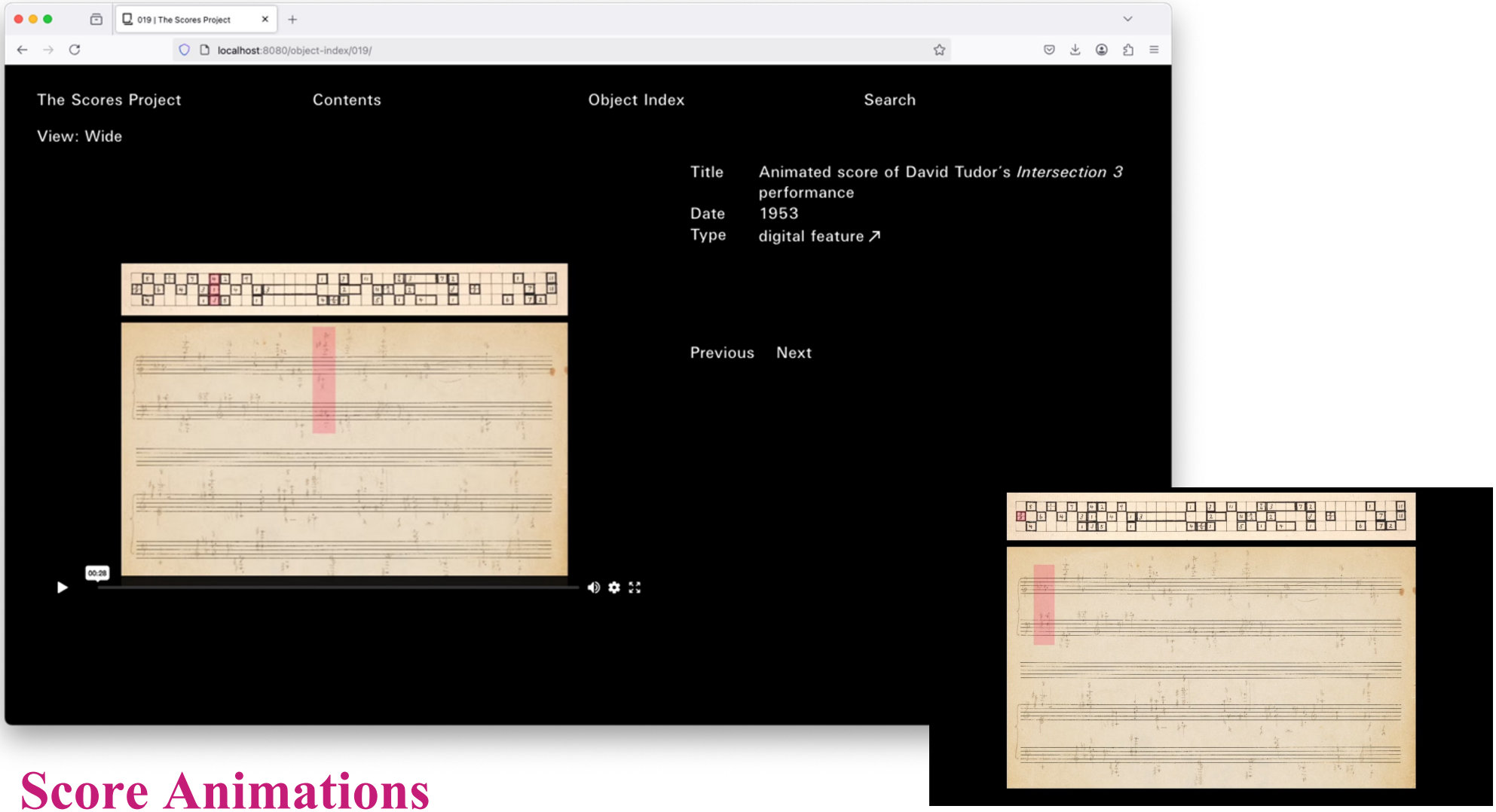
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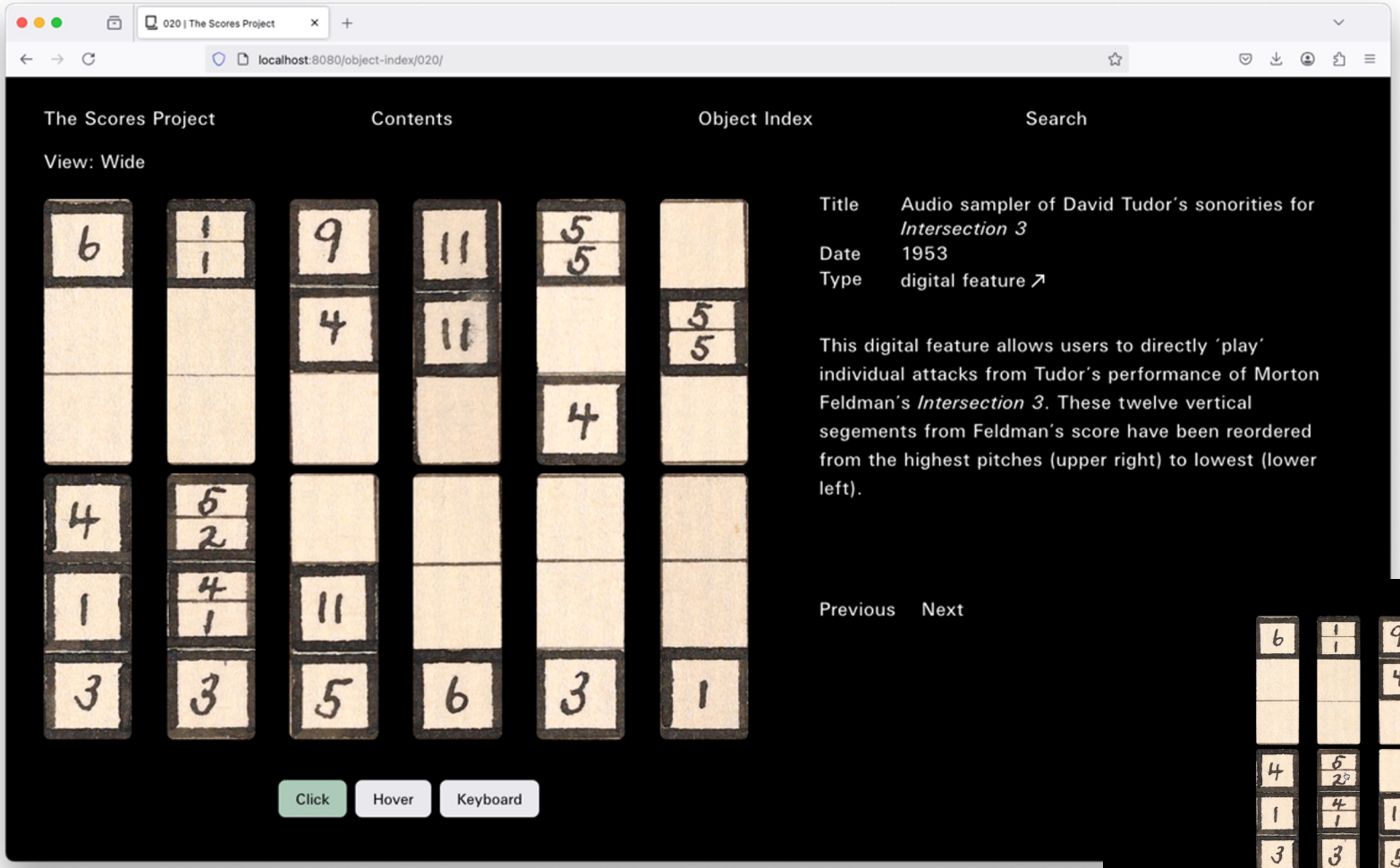
Zooming Images

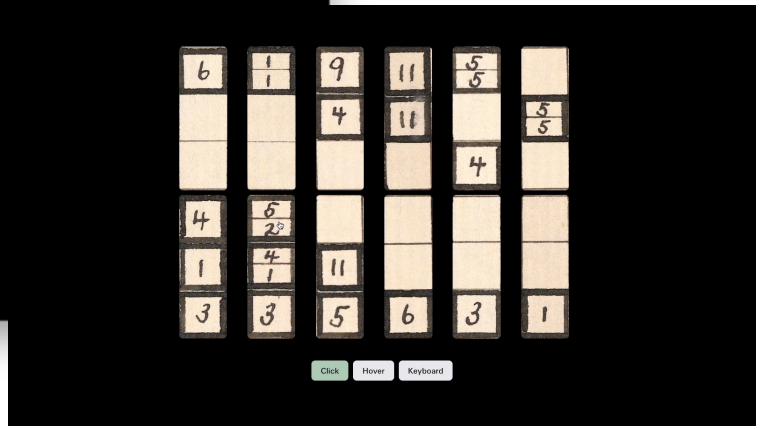


Audio Visualizations



Score Animations


020 | The Scores Project
localhost:8080/object-index/020/
The Scores Project
Contents
Object Index
Search
View: Wide
Title Audio sampler of David Tudor's sonorities for Intersection 3
Date 1953
Type digital feature ↗
This digital feature allows users to directly 'play' individual attacks from Tudor's performance of Morton Feldman's Intersection 3. These twelve vertical segements from Feldman's score have been reordered from the highest pitches (upper right) to lowest (lower left).
Previous
Next
Click
Hover
Keyboard


Click
Hover
Keyboard

Samplers

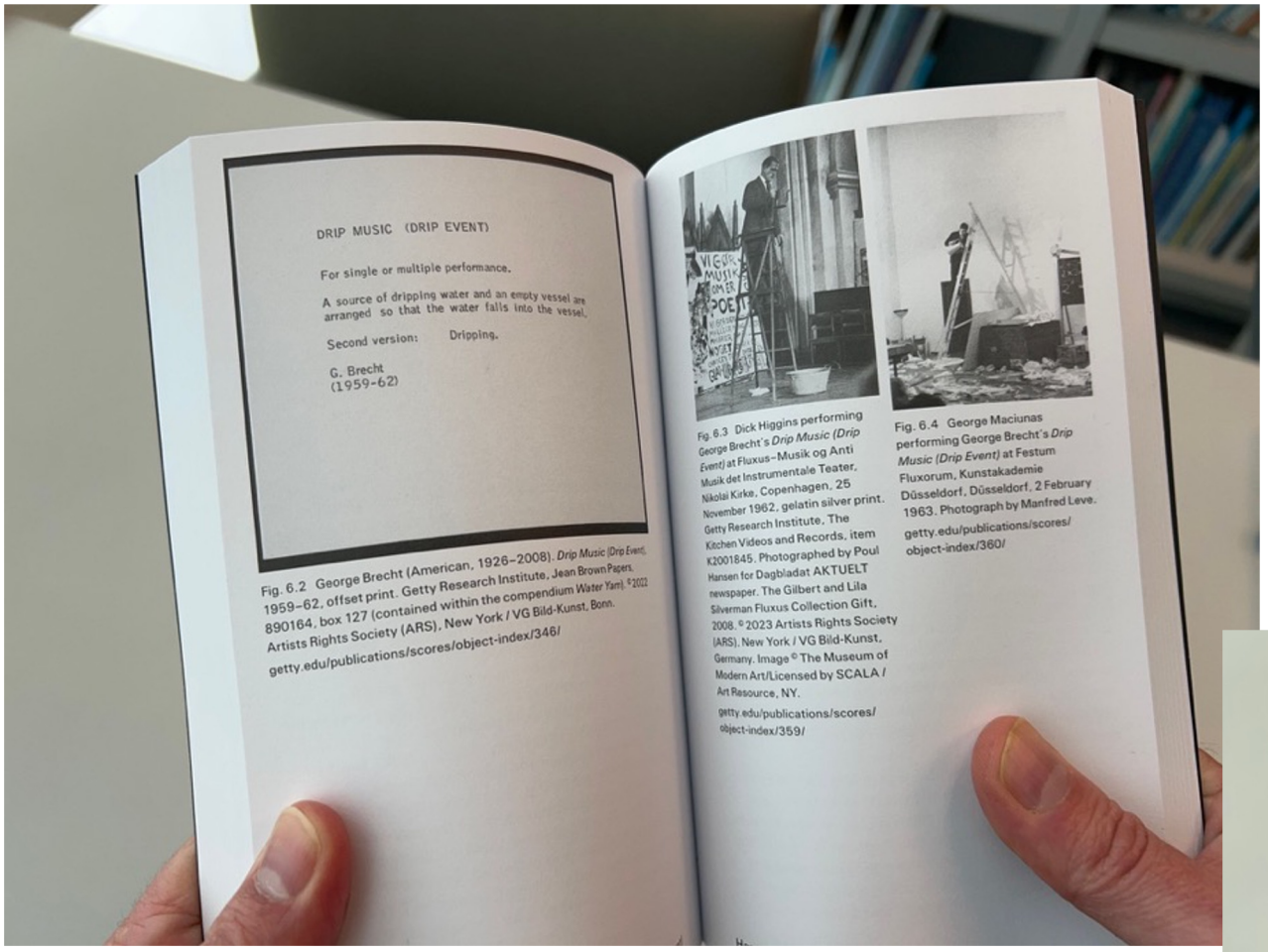
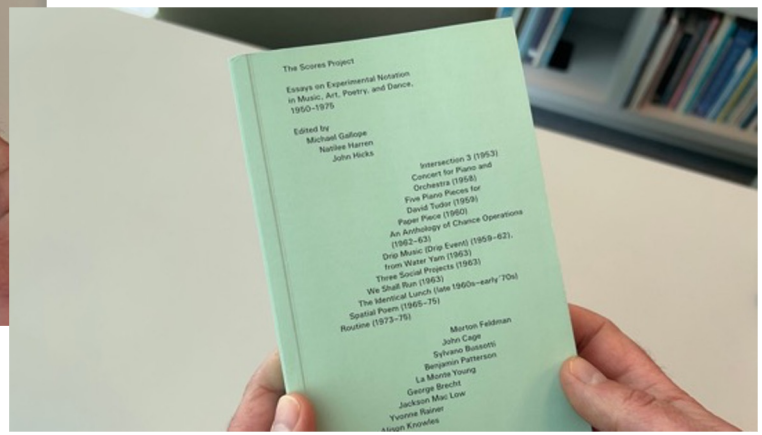


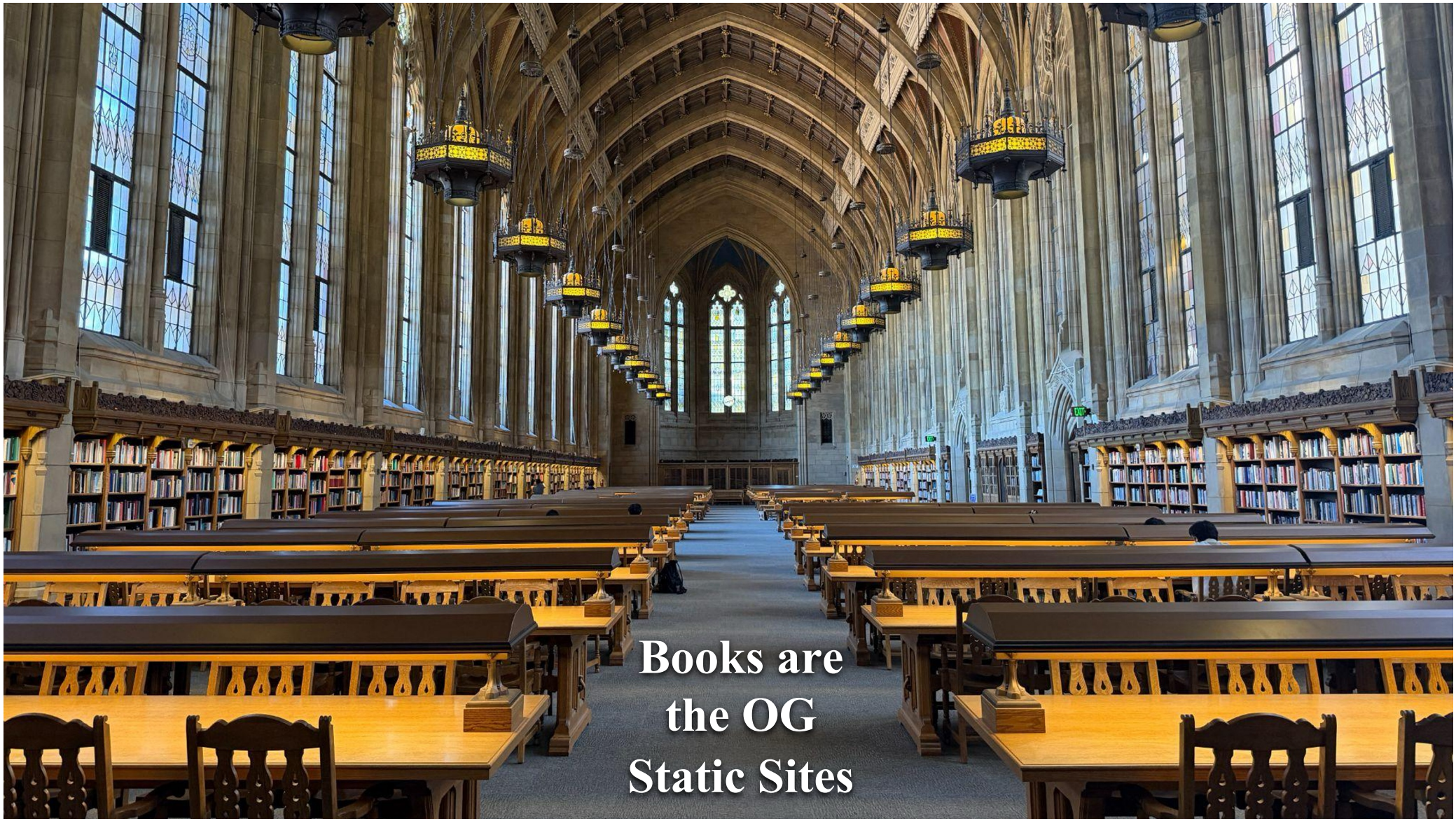
Fig. 6.2 George Brecht (American, 1926–2008). *Drip Music (Drip Event)*, 1959–62, offset print. Getty Research Institute, Jean Brown Papers, 890164, box 127 (contained within the compendium *Water Yam*). © 2022 Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York / VG Bild-Kunst, Bonn.
getty.edu/publications/scores/object-index/346/

Fig. 6.3 Dick Higgins performing George Brecht's *Drip Music (Drip Event)* at Fluxus–Musik og Anti Musik det Instrumentale Teater, Nikolai Kirke, Copenhagen, 25 November 1962, gelatin silver print. Getty Research Institute, The Kitchen Videos and Records, item K2001845. Photographed by Poul Hansen for Dagbladat AKTUELT newspaper. The Gilbert and Lila Silverman Fluxus Collection Gift, 2008. © 2023 Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York / VG Bild-Kunst, Germany. Image © The Museum of Modern Art/Licensed by SCALA / Art Resource, NY.
getty.edu/publications/scores/object-index/359/

Fig. 6.4 George Maciunas performing George Brecht's *Drip Music (Drip Event)* at Festum Fluxorum, Kunstakademie Düsseldorf, Düsseldorf, 2 February 1963. Photograph by Manfred Leve.
getty.edu/publications/scores/object-index/360/



Paperback


Books are
the OG
Static Sites

The Ready for Commitment Quiz



- ❑ You want a long-lasting site with little upkeep or database reliance
- ❑ You have time but you're on a tight budget
- ❑ You want to reduce concerns around bandwidth, security issues, plugin vulnerabilities, and bot traffic
- ❑ Your work would benefit from being in multiple formats
- ❑ Your project includes scholarship combined with images, videos, audio, etc.

The Results Are In!

He knelt to the ground and pulled out a ring and said, "Marry me, Juliet. You'll never have to be alone”

- Taylor Swift, *Love Story*

